

your financial sphere. It's all about maturity and patience. If handled well, a couple's money differences should be a source of balance in the relationship. Just as with any of your other differences—cultural, religious, or otherwise—this is yet another way that you can learn from each other.

This is what I've witnessed with my friend, director Carly Usdin, who is a spender, and her wife, photographer Robin Roemer, who is a saver. Carly said being with Robin has provided her financial accountability that she didn't have when she was single. "Robin has absolutely made me want to plan for the future." She added that she's definitely better with money now than when she first met her wife.

On the flip side, Robin said that being with Carly encouraged her to treat herself to things she really needs. "She helps me with the guilt I have after we go on a trip or I buy something nice," she said. "She talks me off that ledge."

So while money is an important thing to be on the same page about in a relationship, it can also be illuminating to date someone with different qualities than yours if you can ensure that you'll be honest, willing to compromise, and good influences on each other's spending and saving.

My BuzzFeed ex taught me to be much smarter with money. It's to his credit that I now pay an incredibly low amount on rent. When I used to talk about making more money and moving somewhere better, my ex would steer me away from that idea, saying, "As you make more money, save it, and don't change your lifestyle." In Judd Apatow's book *Sick in the Head*, comedian Sarah Silverman says she does the same thing. Despite her success, she still rents a small apartment in LA and has intentionally never moved anywhere more lavish. I hold my ex's—and Silverman's—advice close to my heart. It was only once we split up that I realized how much of an influence he'd had on me—forcing me to make more responsible choices (which I'm sure he'd be thrilled to hear, if he ever wanted to talk to me again).

Rockman, the *HuffPost* relationships editor, said all couples need to discuss finances once the relationship gets serious, ideally even before then, rather than assuming it'll all magically work out. She gave the example of one partner believing spending \$500 on a purse was no big deal while the other wasn't raised to spend that way, or even smaller examples, like one partner saving money by